The Sun Who Said Goodnight Slowly

A bedtime story for ages 3–8 · about 4 minutes to read aloud

Every evening, the Sun has a lot of goodnights to say.

First she says goodnight to the tall buildings. She paints their windows gold, and they shine like they're full of honey.

Then she says goodnight to the trees. Their shadows stretch out long, long, long across the grass, like they're yawning.

"Why are you so slow?" asked a little cloud. "The Moon just pops up and says hello."

"Saying goodnight is important," said the Sun. "This is my favourite part of the day. People call it golden hour."

She said goodnight to the cows in the field, and their backs turned warm and orange. She said goodnight to the river, and it sparkled pink.

She said goodnight to a little girl walking home with her dad. The girl stopped and pointed. "Look, Dad. The sky is on fire."

"Not on fire," said her dad. "It's just the Sun, saying goodnight."

Lower and lower the Sun went, until only the very top of her peeked over the hill.

"Goodnight, little cloud," she said. And the cloud blushed bright pink.

Then she was gone, and the sky turned a soft, deep blue, the colour of a sleepy blanket. People call that blue hour.

One by one, the stars came out to keep watch. The Moon climbed up and smiled at everyone.

And the Sun, tucked behind the hill, closed her eyes and dreamed about tomorrow morning, when she would get to say good morning all over again.

The end.

For grown-ups: The golden glow before sunset (golden hour) and the soft blue after it (blue hour) are real. Asterfold is a free iPhone app that shows tonight's sunset and golden hour times for where you are. · Free story from Honest Little Apps · honestlittleapps.github.io/bedtime-stories